## THE UN AND HUMAN RIGHTS

The Preamble to the UN Charter of 1945 contains a number of provisions pertaining to the promotion of human rights. It proclaims, “We the peoples of the United Nations, determined…to reaffirm faith in fundamental human rights, in the dignity and worth of the human person, in the equal rights of men and women and of nations large and small…have resolved to combine our efforts to accomplish these aims”. The purpose set forth in the Preamble among others is “to cooperate…in promoting respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms for all”. Article 1(3) stating the purposes and principles of the UN, envisages, “To achieve international co-operation in solving international problems of an economic, social, cultural, or humanitarian character, and in promoting and encouraging respect for human rights and for fundamental freedoms for all without distinction as to race, sex, language, or religion”. Article 55 calls for promotion of, inter alia, “universal respect for, and observance of human rights and fundamental freedoms for all without distinction as to race, sex, language or religion”.[5] Apart from the UN Charter, a major breakthrough in the development of an international human rights regime was achieved when the UN General Assembly adopted the Universal Declaration of Human Rights on 10 December, 1948. Since then, 10 December is observed as the World Human Rights Day.

The Preamble to the Declaration embodies that “recognition of the inherent dignity and of the equal and inalienable rights of all members of the human family is the foundation of freedom, justice and peace in the world, whereas disregard and contempt for human rights have resulted in barbarous acts which have outraged the conscience of mankind, and the advent of a world in which human beings shall enjoy freedom of speech and belief and freedom from fear and want has been proclaimed as the highest aspiration of common people”. The General Assembly proclaimed that “this UNIVERSAL DECLARATION OF HUMAN RIGHTS as a common standard of achievement for all peoples and all nations, to the end that every individual and every organ of society, keeping this Declaration constantly in mind, shall strive by teaching and